07-01 第二篇

Learning to Manage Your Time

Time is something everyone has in equal measure—twenty-four hours a day. Yet some people seem to achieve much more than others in the same amount of time. The difference often comes down to how well they manage it. [1] That is, good time management is not about working harder but about working smarter—knowing what to do first, how to avoid distractions, and when to rest. Whether you are a student preparing for exams, an athlete training for a competition, or simply someone who wants more free time, learning to manage your time well can change your life. This article shares practical tips to help you take control of your day.

Set clear goals and priorities. [2] Start each day or week by writing down what you need to accomplish. Then rank your tasks by importance—what must be done today, what can wait, and what is optional. Focus on the most important tasks first, when your energy is highest. This simple habit prevents you from wasting time on things that do not matter much. It also gives you a sense of direction, so you do not drift from one thing to another without purpose. Remember: being busy is not the same as being productive. The goal is to spend your time on what truly counts.

Break big tasks into small steps. [3] Large projects can feel overwhelming, and it is easy to put them off. Instead of thinking about the whole task at once, divide it into smaller, manageable pieces. For example, if you have a long essay to write, start with an outline, then write one paragraph at a time. Each small step you finish gives you a sense of progress and keeps you motivated. Set a timer for twenty or thirty minutes and focus on just one step—this is sometimes called the Pomodoro technique. Small wins add up, and before you know it, the big task is done.

Avoid common time wasters. [4] Social media, endless online videos, and unnecessary phone notifications can eat up hours without you even noticing. Set specific times for checking your phone or browsing the internet, and stick to those limits. Learn to say no to activities that do not match your goals. Find a quiet place to study or work where distractions are fewer. It can also help to tell friends or family about your schedule, so they respect your focused time. The time you save from avoiding distractions can be used for things that truly bring you joy or move you closer to your goals.

[5] Managing your time is a skill, and like any skill, it improves with practice. Start with one or two of the tips above and build from there. You will not be perfect at first, and that is completely fine. The important thing is to keep trying and adjusting your approach. Over time, you will find that you have more free time, less stress, and a greater sense of achievement. Your future self will be grateful for the habits you build today. Take the first step now—plan your tomorrow tonight.

选项

A. That is, good time management is not about working harder but about working smarter—knowing what to do first, how to avoid distractions, and when to rest. B. List your tasks, rank them by importance, and focus on the most critical ones first—being busy is not the same as being productive. C. Break large tasks into smaller steps and focus on one at a time—small wins keep you motivated and the big task gets done. D. Limit social media, set phone-checking times, and find a quiet workspace—saving time from distractions lets you focus on what matters. E. Time management is a skill that improves with practice—start small, keep adjusting, and enjoy more free time and less stress. F. For example, some students use colour-coded planners to organise their homework and revision schedules.

答案键（Answer Key）

[1] A [2] B [3] C [4] D [5] E

深度解析

- **[1] A**：
  - **线索**：空前描述"Time...everyone has twenty-four hours...some achieve more...difference comes down to how well they manage it"，空后说明"Whether student preparing exams, athlete training, someone who wants more free time...learning to manage time well can change life...practical tips"。A选项"That is, good time management is not about working harder but about working smarter—knowing what to do first, how to avoid distractions, and when to rest"（即，好的时间管理不是更努力，而是更聪明——知道先做什么、如何避免干扰、何时休息）中"That is"承接空前概述，"working smarter...what to do first...avoid distractions...rest"与空后"practical tips...take control"精准呼应，衔接顺畅。
- **[2] B**：
  - **线索**：空前提出"Set clear goals and priorities"，空后详述"Start each day or week—write down what need to accomplish...Rank tasks by importance—must be done, can wait, optional...Focus most important first...energy highest...prevents wasting time...sense of direction...not drift...being busy not same as productive...spend time on what truly counts"。B选项"List your tasks, rank them by importance, and focus on the most critical ones first—being busy is not the same as being productive"（列出任务、按重要性排序、先做最关键的——忙碌不等于高效）中"list tasks...rank importance...focus critical first...busy not productive"与空后内容完美对应，逻辑紧密。

- [3] C：
  - **线索**：空前提出"Break big tasks into small steps"，空后列举"Large projects overwhelming...easy put off...divide into smaller manageable pieces...long essay—start outline, one paragraph at a time...small step—sense of progress, motivated...timer twenty or thirty minutes—Pomodoro...Small wins add up...big task done"。C选项"Break large tasks into smaller steps and focus on one at a time—small wins keep you motivated and the big task gets done"（把大任务拆成小步骤，一次专注一个——小胜利保持动力，大任务就完成了）中"break large...smaller steps...one at a time...small wins...motivated...big task done"与空后内容精准对应，衔接自然。
- [4] D：
  - **线索**：空前提出"Avoid common time wasters"，空后描述"Social media, online videos, phone notifications...eat up hours...Set specific times checking phone, browsing internet...stick to limits...say no...do not match goals...quiet place...fewer distractions...tell friends, family about schedule...respect focused time...time saved...joy...closer to goals"。D选项"Limit social media, set phone-checking times, and find a quiet workspace—saving time from distractions lets you focus on what matters"（限制社交媒体、设定查手机时间、找安静的工作空间——从干扰中省下的时间让你专注于重要的事）中"limit social media...phone-checking times...quiet workspace...saving time...distractions...focus on what matters"与空后表述完美对应，衔接得当。
- [5] E：
  - **线索**：空[5]位于结尾段段首，空后为"Managing your time is a skill, and like any skill, it improves with practice. Start with one or two of the tips above and build from there. You will not be perfect at first, and that is completely fine. The important thing is to keep trying and adjusting your approach. Over time, you will find that you have more free time, less stress, and a greater sense of achievement. Your future self will be grateful for the habits you build today. Take the first step now—plan your tomorrow tonight."。E选项"Time management is a skill that improves with practice—start small, keep adjusting, and enjoy more free time and less stress"（时间管理是一项通过练习提高的技能——从小处开始、不断调整、享受更多自由时间和更少压力）用"skill...practice...start small...adjusting...free time, less stress"总结主题，与空后"skill...improves with practice...start...keep trying, adjusting...more free time, less stress"形成呼应，收束精准。
- **干扰项分析**：
  - **F. For example, some students use colour-coded planners to organise their homework and revision schedules.**：涉及学生使用彩色规划本，易被误填[2]。但F以"For example"引出具体工具，而空[2]讨论设定目标和优先级的方法论（列任

务、排序、聚焦重要任务)，F的"colour-coded planners"属于具体工具举例，与"list tasks...rank importance...focus critical"的策略层面焦点不同。F属"主题相关但论述层次错位"型干扰。